

First Week After Pentecost

In Festo Smae Trinitatis

1962 TLM: Trinity Sunday and the one divine Name

Source note. In the 1962 Missale Romanum the Sunday after Pentecost is the feast of the Most Holy Trinity. The distinct Mass of the First Sunday after Pentecost, beginning *Domine, in tua misericordia speravi*, is appointed for available ferial days of the week; it is noted here to prevent its texts from being blended into the feast's proper sequence or preparation module.

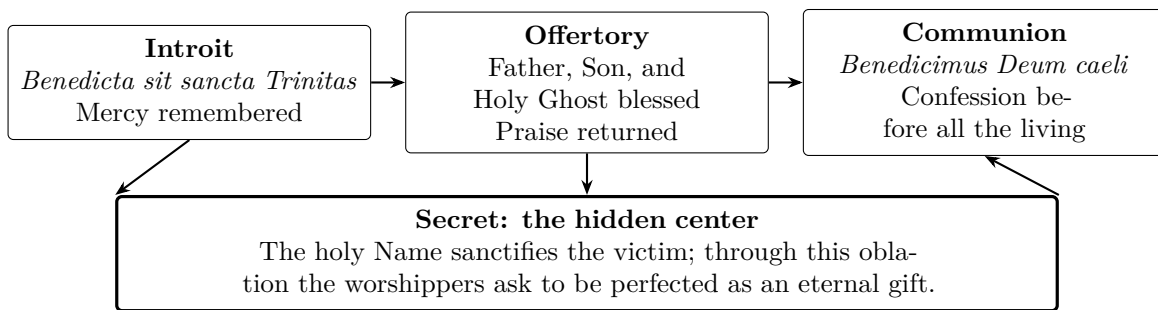
Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas</i> (Tob. 12:6; Ps. 8:2)	Blessing for mercy	Before explaining the mystery, the Church blesses the Trinity and remembers mercy received.
Collect	True faith: acknowledge Trinity, adore unity	Confession and protection	Firmness in the confessed faith guards the worshipper from adversity.
Epistle	Rom. 11:33-36	Unsearchable wisdom	Paul's inquiry ends in wonder and praise: all things are from, through, and unto God.
Gradual	<i>Benedictus es, Domine, qui intueris abyssos</i> (Dan. 3:55-56)	Abyss and throne	God sees the depths and reigns above the Cherubim; human unsearching yields to revealed praise.
Alleluia	<i>Benedictus es, Domine Deus patrum nostrorum</i> (Dan. 3:52)	Inherited praise	The God of the fathers is blessed for ever as the Church ascends to the Gospel.
Gospel	Matt. 28:18-20	One Name, baptism, teaching	Christ joins universal mission to baptism, commanded obedience, and his presence until the end.
Offertory	<i>Benedictus sit Deus Pater... Filius... Spiritus</i> (Tob. 12:6)	Blessing returned	The mercy proclaimed at the entrance becomes the praise carried to the altar.
Communion	<i>Benedicimus Deum caeli</i> (Tob. 12:6)	Public thanksgiving	Reception issues in confession before all the living.
Postcommunion	<i>Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae</i>	Sacrament and confession	Sacramental reception and Trinitarian confession are asked to profit body and soul.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Romans 11 confesses judgments that cannot be searched out; Matthew 28 records Christ's authority, command to baptize and teach, and promise to remain with the apostles until the consummation of the age.
Allegorical	The one baptismal Name reveals the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost and gathers the nations into the teaching and sacramental life of the Church.
Moral	The baptized are not merely to repeat the formula but to observe all that Christ commanded; the Secret extends that obedience into the offering of the self.
Anagogical	Christ's presence reaches to the consummation of the age, while the Secret asks that the worshippers become an eternal gift and Paul's doxology directs all things to God's glory.

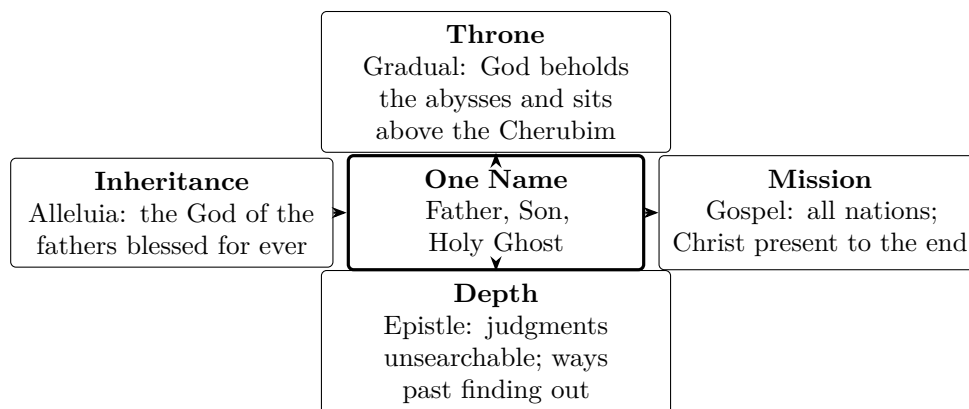
The Trinitarian Ring of Praise

The same passage from Tobit frames three different moments of the Mass. Its recurrence is not static repetition: mercy first awakens praise, praise is carried to the altar, and sacramental reception opens into confession before the world.



The Postcommunion names the fruit of the whole ring: sacramental reception and confession of the eternal Trinity and undivided Unity are to advance the salvation of body and soul. The feast therefore concerns participation and healing, not an abstract diagram detached from worship.

A Coordinate Map of the Feast



The vertical axis prevents intellectual pride: the depth that exceeds human searching is entirely visible to God and governed from his throne. The horizontal axis prevents mystery from becoming remoteness: inherited praise becomes baptism, teaching, and mission among the nations. At their intersection stands the revealed Name, invoked again over the sacrifice.

The Collect gives the reader's posture

The Church asks for true faith to *acknowledge* the glory of the eternal Trinity, to *adore* the Unity in the power of majesty, and to remain guarded by firmness in that faith. Knowledge, worship, and perseverance belong together.

One Name, Three Persons

Feature	What Matthew 28 says	What to notice
Singular Name	The nations are baptized “in the name,” not in three names.	The baptismal formula confesses one God, not a collection of divine beings.
Three named Persons	Father, Son, and Holy Ghost are coordinated within that one Name.	Unity neither erases the Persons nor reduces one to a lesser rank.
Formation	The command moves from making disciples and baptizing to teaching them to observe all Christ commanded.	Baptismal identity unfolds as a taught and obeyed way of life.
Enduring presence	The risen Christ promises, “I am with you,” until the consummation of the age.	Mission rests on presence; its horizon is consummation, not merely expansion.

Doctrinal and exegetical guardrails

- A mystery is truly revealed yet never exhausted. Incomprehensibility forbids mastery, not confession, worship, or careful thought.
- Father, Son, and Holy Ghost are not three parts of God, three roles played by one Person, or three gods.
- Romans 11:36 is a doxology to God in its immediate grammar. Its place on this feast permits Trinitarian contemplation, but *ex ipso*, *per ipsum*, *in ipso* should not be turned into three grammatical names for the Persons.
- The Gradual does not answer Paul's wonder with an explanation. It relocates the reader: human reason looks into a depth that God already sees from the throne.

From Confession to Participation

1. **Revelation received — Introit through Gospel.** Mercy awakens praise; inquiry yields to the God who sees the depth; the one baptismal Name is disclosed for all nations.
2. **Participation enacted — Offertory through Communion.** Praise is returned, the holy Name sanctifies victim and offerers, and the mystery confessed is received as gift.
3. **Fruit and mission — Postcommunion and Gospel horizon.** Body and soul are healed; praise “before all the living” opens again toward teaching and mission.

The altar supplies the decisive transition. The Name that marks baptism also sanctifies the victim, and the offerers ask to become an eternal gift through the oblation. Communion then returns to Tobit's blessing "before all the living," reconnecting sacramental participation with Christ's command to teach the nations.

Four Patristic Lenses

Witness	Text or source status	Interpretive contribution
St. John Chrysostom	Paraphrase, Homily 19 on Romans 11:33: Paul knows the reality of the depth but not its measure, so his language is wonder rather than mastery.	The Epistle models disciplined inquiry whose fitting completion is doxology.
St. Hilary of Poitiers	Direct quotation, <i>De Trinitate</i> II.1: "What element in the mystery of man's salvation is not included in those words? What is forgotten, what left in darkness?"	Matthew 28 gathers Name, baptism, teaching, obedience, presence, and the final horizon into one saving rule.
St. Basil the Great	Paraphrase, <i>De Spiritu Sancto</i> 10.24: Christ's baptismal command ranks the Spirit with Father and Son and cannot be reconciled with treating the Spirit as inferior.	The baptismal formula governs both confession and equal worship.
St. Augustine	Direct quotation, <i>De Trinitate</i> VIII.8.12: "Nay, but you see the Trinity if you see love."	Charity does not replace doctrine; it disposes the baptized to perceive divine communion as gift and participation.

Questions to carry into Mass

- Why do the chants bless God before the readings invite thought about the mystery?
- How do the Epistle's "depth" and the Gradual's "abyss" correct the standpoint of the inquirer?
- What work is done by the singular "Name" and by the three Persons named within it?
- What happens to the victim and to the worshippers in the Secret?
- How does Communion's confession "before all the living" reopen the Gospel's mission?

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* 1962, Proprium de Tempore, *In Festo Ssmae Trinitatis*; local OCR corpus identified in the README. Psalm numbering follows the missal's Vulgate numbering.
- St. Augustine, *De Trinitate* VIII.8.12: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/130108.htm>.
- St. Hilary of Poitiers, *De Trinitate* II.1: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/330202.htm>.
- St. John Chrysostom, Homily 19 on Romans, at Rom. 11:33: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/210219.htm>.
- St. Basil the Great, *De Spiritu Sancto* 10.24: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/3203.htm>.